



THE ABUNDANT EDGE · COMPANION GUIDE



SOIL, ROOT & PLANT ENHANCERS

The minerals, microbes & tonics that turn good soil
into living, electric, abundant earth.

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The plant does not eat minerals. It drinks them through the mouths of fungi, unlocked by microbes, freed from the rock by time. Our work is simply to invite all three to the table.

FROM THE LAND, FOR THE LAND

After years of trials across the Algarve, two enhancers stood above the rest in what they did for our plants and our clients' land:

Mycorrhizal fungi & volcanic basalt rock dust.

Here they are — alongside every other powerful, proven soil and root ally we reach for.



01 · TESTED IN THE ALGARVE

The two that changed everything.



Of all the enhancers we've trialled on dry Mediterranean land, these two made the most visible difference — in our gardens, and in the land of so many people we've worked with. We recommend them in almost every planting.

✿ MYCORRHIZAL FUNGI — *the root extenders*

The single most transformative thing you can add at planting. These fungi colonise the roots and extend their reach **100 to 1000 times**, trading water and minerals — especially phosphorus — for the plant's sugars.

What we saw: stronger establishment, far less transplant shock, deeper drought resilience through the Algarve summer, and visibly healthier, more vigorous plants. This is the wood-wide web, in your hands.

✦ VOLCANIC BASALT ROCK DUST — *the remineraliser*

Mediterranean soils are mineral-tired after thousands of years of farming. Basalt slowly releases **70+ trace minerals** — silica, magnesium, iron, calcium — over years, not weeks.

What we saw: stronger cell walls, better pest and disease resistance, richer flavour, and tired Algarve land slowly waking back up. In Portugal, source it from **Grow It** or **Sementes Vivas**.

*** THE MAGIC PAIR.** Use them together. The basalt provides the minerals; the mycorrhizae deliver them straight into the root. Rock + fungi = the fastest way to wake tired land we've ever found.

02 · WHERE TO BEGIN

Don't buy everything. Start here.



It's easy to feel you need a shed full of products. You don't. Regeneration is about working *with* life, not buying your way to it. Here's the honest path — from free, to a few wise investments.

LEVEL 1
FREE — start today

Forest IMO · comfrey & nettle tea · your own compost · chop-and-drop mulch · wood ash from the fire. Cost: nothing but your time. Power: enormous.

LEVEL 2
SMALL INVESTMENT — the two heroes

Mycorrhizal fungi at planting + basalt rock dust in the soil. If you buy only two things, buy these. The biggest visible difference for the least money.

LEVEL 3
BUILD THE PANTRY — as you grow

Charged biochar · worm castings · kelp/seaweed · rock phosphate · humic & fulvic acids. Add these over seasons, not all at once.

LEVEL 4
FINE-TUNE — for the keen

Compost tea brewing · EM ferments · trichoderma · sea minerals · fish hydrolysate. The seasoning that turns a good garden into an extraordinary one.

*** THE ORACLE'S PROMISE.** You can grow abundance at Level 1 alone. Everything above is acceleration, not requirement. Begin where your budget and energy are today — the land will meet you there.

03 · KNOW YOUR FUNGI & MINERALS

The fungi types & the rock minerals.



✿ Mycorrhizae — which type for what

Endomycorrhizae (AMF)	Arbuscular — for about 80% of plants: vegetables, fruit trees, herbs, grasses, most food crops. Your everyday workhorse.
Ectomycorrhizae	For specific trees: oaks, pines, chestnuts, eucalyptus, birch. Use when planting forest and woodland trees.
Multi-species blends	The best products combine 4–9 species of both types, plus trichoderma and beneficial bacteria. Most versatile for mixed plantings — our usual choice.

✦ Mineral additives — the rock foundation

Basalt rock dust	Full-spectrum remineralisation, slow release over years. Grow It / Sementes Vivas in Portugal.
Rock phosphate	Slow, natural phosphorus for roots, flowers and fruiting. Long-lasting.
Gypsum (gesso agrícola)	Breaks up heavy clay, adds calcium without raising soil pH.
Wood ash	Fast potassium and lime. Use sparingly — it raises pH quickly.
Sea minerals / diluted ocean water	Full trace-mineral spectrum. Your Atlantic gift — dilute well before use.
Azomite / glacial rock dust	Alternative broad-spectrum mineral source if basalt is unavailable.
Diatomaceous earth	Silica for strong cell walls, plus a gentle natural pest deterrent.

04 · WAKE THE BIOLOGY

Living boosters & root tonics.



* Biological boosters — the living engine

Biochar (charged)	Microbial housing + carbon. The Terra Preta key. Always charge before use.
Worm castings / vermicompost	Concentrated biology and gentle nutrients. Gold for seedlings and transplants.
Compost tea / extract	Liquid biology — sprayed on leaves or watered into soil. Multiplies microbes fast.
IMO (forest microbes)	Your free, local, perfectly-adapted inoculant. Gathered from a healthy forest floor.
Trichoderma	Beneficial fungi that protect roots from disease and boost nutrient uptake.
Effective Microorganisms (EM)	Lactic-acid bacteria, yeasts and ferments — powerful allies for soil and compost.
Seaweed / kelp meal	Natural growth hormones (auxins, cytokinins), potassium and trace minerals.

* Plant & root tonics — free or near-free

Comfrey tea / extract	The 'potassium pump' — a free liquid fertiliser from your own comfrey patch.
Nettle tea	Nitrogen and iron tonic for strong, green leafy growth.
Fish hydrolysate / emulsion	Gentle nitrogen plus fungal food. Excellent for fruiting plants.
Aloe vera (fresh blended)	Natural rooting hormone and plant immune booster. A few leaves, blended, diluted.
Willow water	Natural rooting hormone for cuttings — just soak willow twigs in water.
Humic & fulvic acids	Unlock locked nutrients and boost root uptake. Pairs beautifully with biochar.
Molasses (unsulphured)	Feeds soil microbes and kickstarts biology. A splash in your compost tea.

05 · THE CHEAT-SHEET

Simple amounts & common slips.



Rough, friendly guidance — not laboratory precision. Nature is forgiving. When in doubt, less is more, and observe how the plants respond.

♦ Simple dosing guide

Mycorrhizal fungi	A pinch (½–1 tsp) directly on the root ball or in the planting hole. Must touch roots.
Basalt rock dust	A generous handful per planting hole, or 1–2 kg per square metre as a top-dress, once a year.
Charged biochar	Up to 5–10% of the soil volume in a bed. Always charge first — never raw.
Worm castings	A handful per transplant, or a 1–2 cm layer top-dressed around plants.
Comfrey / nettle tea	Dilute 1:10 with water (until it looks like weak tea). Water in every 2–3 weeks.
Seaweed / kelp	Follow pack rate, usually 1:100 diluted as a foliar spray or soil drench.
Wood ash	A light sprinkle only — never piles. Raises pH, so keep it modest.

🌱 Common slips to avoid

- * **Using raw, uncharged biochar** — it steals nitrogen for months. Always charge it first.
- * **Mixing mycorrhizae with strong synthetic fertiliser** — high phosphorus & salts kill the fungi.
- * **Mycorrhizae not touching the root** — sprinkled on top, it does nothing. It must meet the root.
- * **Too much wood ash** — easy to spike pH and lock out nutrients. A light hand only.
- * **Buying everything at once** — overwhelm and waste. Start at Level 1–2 and grow.
- * **Letting it all dry out** — biology needs moisture. Keep the mulch alive and damp.

06 · PUT IT TO WORK

How the Oracle uses them.



At planting — the root zone ritual

- ✿ **Dust the root ball** with mycorrhizal inoculant — it must touch the roots directly to colonise.
- ✿ **A handful of basalt rock dust** in every planting hole — slow mineral feed for years.
- ✿ **A scoop of worm castings + charged biochar** mixed into the hole — instant biology + housing.
- ✿ **Water in with diluted seaweed or compost tea** — wakes everything up on day one.

Through the season — the living top-up

- ✿ **Comfrey or nettle tea** every few weeks as a free liquid feed.
- ✿ **Compost tea spray** on leaves and soil to keep biology thriving.
- ✿ **A light basalt top-dress** once a year, worked gently into the mulch.
- ✿ **Never bare soil** — keep the mulch crown alive so all this biology stays moist.

* **THE ORACLE'S RULE OF THUMB.** Minerals are the pantry. Biology is the cook. Fungi are the waiters. Tonics are the seasoning. You don't need all of them at once — start with mycorrhizae and basalt, add the rest as you grow.

*"Feed the rock to the fungi, the fungi to the root,
the root to the plant, the plant to your people.
This is how the mountain becomes the meal."*

✿ NOT SURE WHERE TO START? LET'S TALK. ✿

Every piece of land is different — and a little guidance saves years of guessing. Benjy & Sofia help you see what your land wants and exactly what to do next.

LAND PLANNING — what to plant, where, in what order

FOOD FOREST SET-UP — from blank land to living, edible ecosystem

GARDEN & PROPERTY DESIGN — beds, pathways, water, zones, beauty

SOIL & PLANTING PLANS — the right enhancers for *your* exact soil

ON-SITE WEEKENDS & WORKSHOPS — we walk the land with you

Start with a **FREE 30-minute clarity call** — let's feel into your vision together.

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Tomar, Portugal · serving land & lovers of the Earth worldwide

From our hands to your soil. ✿🌱 © Benjy Bananas & Sofia · Regenerative Eden